

*Mr. D.*

One can imagine Mr. D waking in the early morning, yet not too early, alone or perhaps beside some sort of undemanding pet, a cat or perhaps even a tortoise. And one can *only* imagine him waking up in this way. Hanging in some dedicated section of his wardrobe, properly designated in relation to its convenience and superiority over all other possible sections, he has prepared the night before, with a complete lack of imagination, his outfit for the day. His thoughts need not this form of foreseeing care, because he rarely changes them. He is, our fin Mr. D, a truly harmless, even well-intentioned man, of the special kind whose harmlessness seems mystically linked to a total lack of competence, talent, or any kind of outstanding features. Looking at him, one feels his soul must either be utterly shapeless, or a mere reflection of his extraordinarily frail figure, and perhaps his small, timid eyes, his hookish and protruding nose, his nervous smile themselves conform already something of a spiritual visage, a kind of revelation. Nothing bad could be said about this man: such a thing would already transgress against his indetermination. A fine man, Mr. D, neither hated nor loved, seen and then forgotten, a child, a well-intentioned soul.